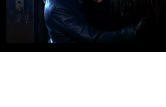




Overly Honest Reviews

Delving into the world of films, series, books, and music.

WHAT'S HOT



Every Alias Leaves Something Behind



Search

Search

Recent Posts

Every Alias Leaves Something Behind

His Silence Leaves Too Much Unanswered

Silence Carries Farther Than Gunfire

Reacher Finds Strength in Restraint

Class Lines Disguised As Romance

Recent Comments

Chris Jones on Healing Isn't a Straight Line

HELENA NOVAK on Healing Isn't a Straight Line

FANTASIA 2026: APOCRYPHA CANDIDATE: GODHEAD (2026) | 366 Weird Movies on Horror Under Holy Pressure

Chris Jones on Between Fact and Myth Lies an Intriguing Story

Matt George on Between Fact and Myth Lies an Intriguing Story

Archives

August 2026

July 2026

June 2026

May 2026

April 2026

March 2026

February 2026

January 2026

December 2025

November 2025

October 2025

September 2025

August 2025

July 2025

June 2025

May 2025

April 2025

March 2025

February 2025

January 2025

December 2024

November 2024

October 2024

September 2024

August 2024

July 2024

June 2024

May 2024

April 2024

March 2024

February 2024

January 2024

December 2023

November 2023

October 2023

September 2023

August 2023

July 2023

June 2023

May 2023

April 2023

March 2023

February 2023

January 2023

December 2022

November 2022

October 2022

September 2022

August 2022

July 2022

June 2022

May 2022

April 2022

March 2022

February 2022

January 2022

December 2021

November 2021

October 2021

September 2021

August 2021

July 2021

June 2021

May 2021

April 2021

March 2021

February 2021

January 2021

0

Categories

Adult Reviews

Annecy International Animation Film Festival

Berlin International Film Festival

Cannes Film Festival

Cheating Wife POV

CPH.DOX

Dances With Films

Digital

DVD/Blu-Ray/4K

EnjoyX

Fantasia International Film Festival

Fantastic Fest Film festival

Film Festival

Hot Docs

In Theaters

In Theaters/Digital

International

Interview

LA New Girl

Make Believe Seattle Film Festival

Movie News

New Release information

Overlook Film Festival

Pink Label

Pre-order

Redemption TV/Salvation Films

Slamdance

Sundance

SXSW

Team Skeet

Toronto International Film Festival

Tribeca

Uncategorized

Venice Film Festival

• Home • A Patient Drama With Frayed Edges

A Patient Drama With Frayed Edges



A Patient Drama With Frayed Edges

Chris Jones — June 23, 2026

Share

Read Time: 5 Minute, 29 Second

MOVIE REVIEW

For the Love of a Woman (Per amore di una donna)

(NOT RATED) — ★★★★★

Genre: Romantic Drama / Historical Drama

Year Released: 2025, 2026

Runtime: 1h 57m

Director: Guido Chiesa

Writers: Nicoletta Micheli, Guido Chiesa

Cast: Mili Avital, Ana Ularu, Ori Pfeffer, Alban Ukaj, Marc Rissmann, Serhii Kysil, Anastasia Doaga, Sira Topic, Limor Goldstein, Vincenzo Nemolato, Menashe Noy, Mori Moshonov

Where to Watch: in select theaters starting June 26, 2026; New York at Quad Cinema beginning June 26, Los Angeles at Laemmle Royal and Encino at Laemmle Town Center beginning July 10



RAVING REVIEW: FOR THE LOVE OF A WOMAN understands that family history rarely comes with a perfect explanation. It comes through fragments, omissions, letters left too late, and people who spent decades surviving choices they never learned how to name. Guido Chiesa's adaptation of Meir Shalev's THE LOVES OF JUDITH reaches for that uneasy space between mystery and inheritance, following Esther Horwitz, an American woman in the 1970s whose mother's death sends her toward Israel and toward a buried story from British Mandate Palestine. The movie has the shape of a romantic historical saga, but its better instincts are quieter than that. A daughter trying to understand why love, shame, and silence have been passed down to her like family property.

Mili Avital plays Esther as a woman who seems both restless and emotionally stalled. She isn't shown as someone chasing adventure. She's looking for an answer because the alternative is to continue living with a blank space where her own story should be. That gives the 1970s portion an ache, especially once Esther meets Zayde Rabinovich, played by Ori Pfeffer, a professor whose knowledge of the past comes with private wounds of his own. Their scenes often work less as romance than as a partnership between two people who recognize sadness in each other before they know what to do with it.

The earlier timeline belongs to Yehudit Salomon, played by Ana Ularu, whose arrival in a 1930s settlers' village unsettles three men. Moshe, a widowed father; Yaakov, an idealist with his head half in the clouds; and Globerman, a cattle trader whose pragmatism carries its own kind of threat. Chiesa and co-writer Nicoletta Micheli build the film by moving between Esther's investigation and Yehudit's life, letting the past and present gradually press against each other. That structure gives FOR THE LOVE OF A WOMAN a hook, and the mystery of Esther's origins keeps the story moving even when the film's emotional pulse slows.

Ularu gives the film a compelling presence. Yehudit could have been reduced to an object of fascination, the mysterious woman who inspires desire, rivalry, projection, and damage. Ularu pushes against that by giving her a life that doesn't always show itself through dialogue. Her face carries calculation, disappointment, fury, and exhaustion in small shifts, and the film needs that because the men around Yehudit often see her more as an idea than as a person. Alban Ukaj, Marc Rissmann, and Serhii Kysil each bring distinctiveness to these portrayals, though the writing sometimes reduces them to simple versions before they become complex.

Chiesa's film is at its best when it lets contradiction remain in the room. FOR THE LOVE OF A WOMAN is dealing with motherhood, exile, violence, desire, chosen family, and the painful need to know where you came from. It also places its story in a historical setting that can't help but carry political implications, even when the film insists on approaching that world through personal drama rather than direct political argument. That choice is understandable, and the story need not become a lecture.

Avital and Pfeffer help keep the 1970s timeline grounded through their restraint. Esther and Zayde could have slipped into melodramatic convenience, two wounded people bonded by a shared investigation and a few too many buried secrets. Their connection is more interesting when it stays speculative. Pfeffer gives Zayde a guarded warmth that works well against Avital's brittle uncertainty, and their scenes carry the sense of adults who have learned to function without mistaking that for healing. The film's quieter exchanges between them are often more persuasive than its larger romantic or tragic gestures.

The production has a period-drama quality that will appeal to audiences drawn to literary adaptations and multigenerational family stories. Emanuele Pasquet's cinematography gives the earlier material an inviting feel, while Zoë Keating's music supports the film's mournful, searching tone without overwhelming every scene.

FOR THE LOVE OF A WOMAN is an emotionally earnest drama with strong source material, a thoughtful adaptation, and a cast capable of suggesting more than the script always gives them. As it stands, Chiesa's film is valuable but uneven. It has an effective performance, a solid mystery framework, and enough literary richness to carry viewers through its slower patches. It occasionally overexplains, softens some of its more difficult implications, and occasionally reaches for grandeur when a more intimate wound would have cut deeper. FOR THE LOVE OF A WOMAN works best as a story about inheritance, not just the secrets families keep, but the emotional habits they leave behind. That version of the film is strong enough to make the journey meaningful, even when the destination feels more composed than devastating.

Please visit <https://linktr.ee/overlyhonestr> for more reviews.

You can follow me on Letterboxd, Instagram, Twitter, and YouTube. My social media accounts can also be found on most platforms by searching for 'Overly Honest Reviews'.

I'm always happy to hear from my readers; please don't hesitate to say hello or send me any questions about movies.

[photo courtesy of PANORAMA FILMS, VIVO FILM]

DISCLAIMER:

At Overly Honest Movie Reviews, we value honesty and transparency. Occasionally, we receive complimentary items for review, including DVDs, Blu-rays, CDs, Vinyl Records, Books, and more. We assure you that these arrangements do not influence our reviews, as we are committed to providing unbiased and sincere evaluations. We aim to help you make informed entertainment choices regardless of our relationship with distributors or producers.

Amazon Affiliate Links:

Additionally, this site contains Amazon affiliate links. If you purchase through these links, we may receive a commission. This affiliate arrangement does not affect our commitment to honest reviews and helps support our site. We appreciate your trust and support as you navigate these links.

About Post Author
Chris Jones
✉ OverlyHonestMR@gmail.com
🌐 <https://mailnewsgroup.com/ohmr/>

Happy
0%

Sad
0%

Excited
0%

Sleepy
0%

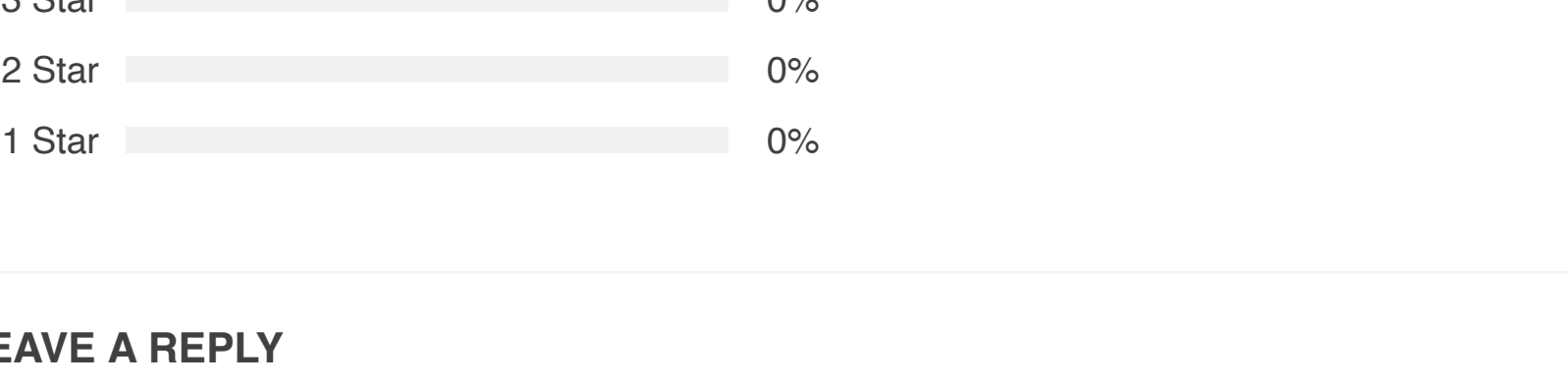
Angry
0%

Surprise
0%

0

0

Average Rating



LEAVE A REPLY

Your email address will not be published. Required fields are marked *

Comment *

Rating*

★★★★★

Name *

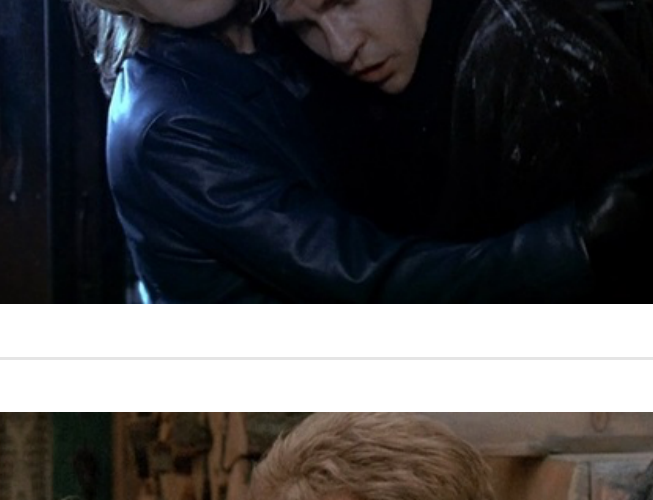
Email *

Website

☐ Save my name, email, and website in this browser for the next time I comment.

Post Comment

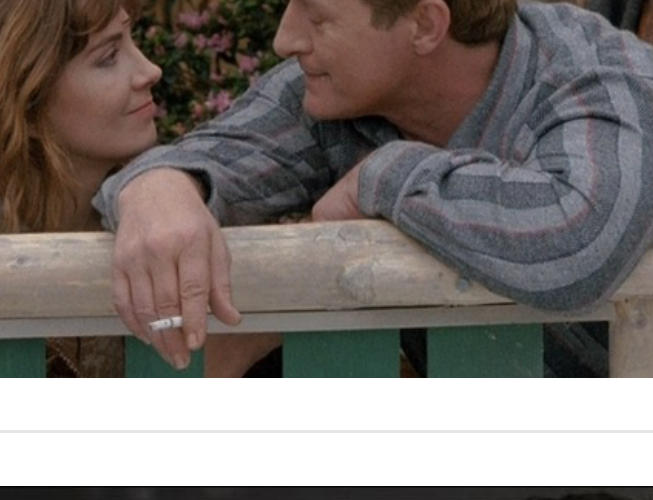
MORE STORIES



Every Alias Leaves Something Behind

MOVIE REVIEW The Saint (Steelbook) - Genre: Action, Adventure, Romance, Thriller
Year Released: 1997, 2026 Steelbook Runtime: 1h 56m Director:...

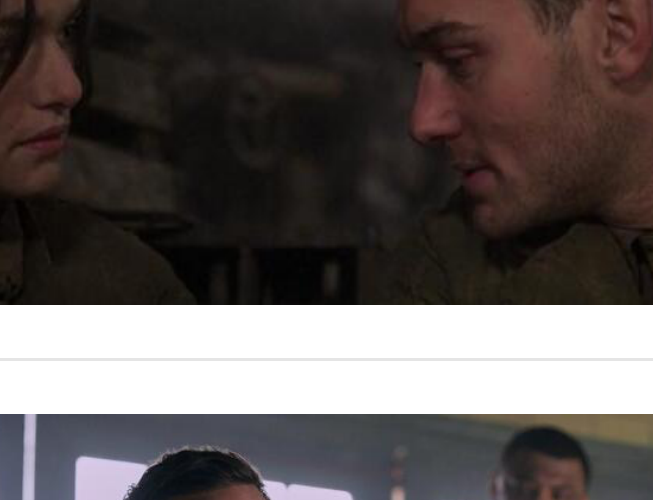
Chris Jones — August 19, 2026



His Silence Leaves Too Much Unanswered

MOVIE REVIEW Past Midnight (Retro VHS Packaging) - Genre: Mystery, Thriller, Romance
Year Released: 1991, 2026 Blu-ray Runtime: 1h 40m...

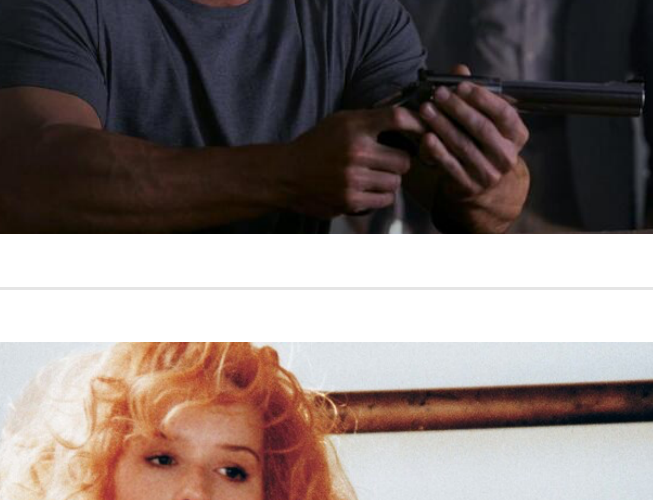
Chris Jones — August 19, 2026



Silence Carries Farther Than Gunfire

MOVIE REVIEW Enemy at the Gates (Steelbook) - Genre: War, Drama, History Year
Released: 2001, 2026 Steelbook Runtime: 2h 11m...

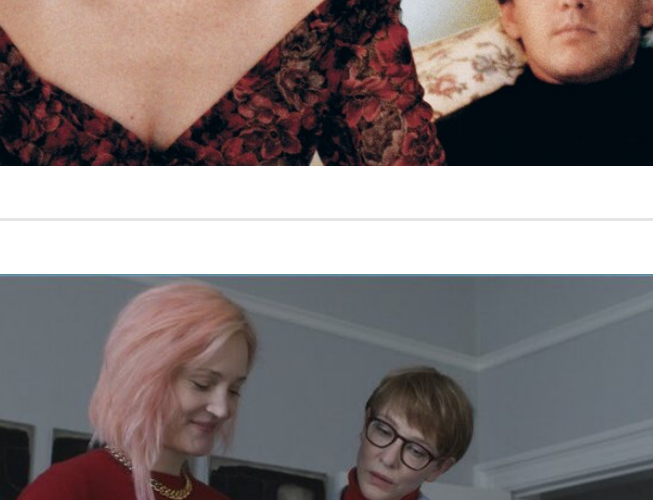
Chris Jones — August 19, 2026



Reacher Finds Strength in Restraint

MOVIE REVIEW Reacher: Season Three (Blu-ray) - Genre: Action, Crime, Drama, Thriller
Year Released: 2025, 2026 DVD/Blu-ray Runtime: 6h 25m...

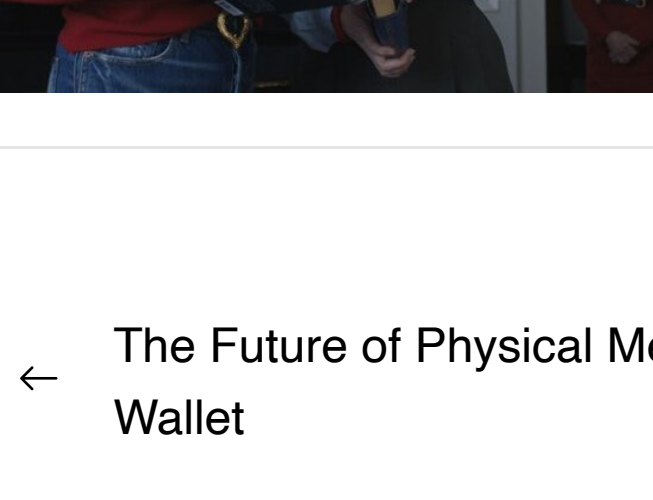
Chris Jones — August 18, 2026



Class Lines Disguised As Romance

MOVIE REVIEW Fresh Horses (Retro VHS) (Blu-ray) - Genre: Drama, Romance Year
Released: 1988, 2026 Blu-ray Runtime: 1h 45m Director:...

Chris Jones — August 18, 2026



The Distance Between Blood Relatives

MOVIE REVIEW Father Mother Sister Brother (Blu-ray) - Genre: Comedy, Drama Year
Released: 2025, 2026 Blu-ray Runtime: 1h 50m Director:...

Chris Jones — August 18, 2026



The Future of Physical Media Fits in Your

Wallet

Chicago Becomes an Audition



PREVIOUS POST

NEXT POST